

Word family: **trap / traps / trapped / trapping / trapper / entrap / entrapment**

Base word: trap

Past tense / past participle: trapped

ing form: trapping

Related forms:

* **trap** (n.) — 陷阱；圈套；困境

* **trap** (v.) — 捕捉；困住；使陷入

* **trapped** (adj./participle) — 被困住的；陷入困境的

* **trapping** (n.) — 捕捉動物；設陷阱捕獵

* **trapper** (n.) — 設陷阱捕捉動物的人

* **entrap** (v.) — 誘使；使落入圈套

* **entrapment** (n.) — 誘捕；設局誘使犯罪

Useful extensions:

* **animal trap**

* **set a trap**

* **fall into a trap**

* **trap someone/something**

* **be trapped in/inside**

* **be trapped by something**

* **feel trapped**

* **trap someone into doing something**

* **trapped in routine**

* **trapped in a relationship**

* **poverty trap**

* **debt trap**

* **tourist trap**

* **speed trap**

* **trapdoor / trap door**

* **mouse trap / mousetrap**

Meaning in this passage

> Adults often get **trapped in routine**, whereas children like Leo can turn an ordinary afternoon into a little adventure.

Here, **trapped** is **figurative**.

It means:

to become stuck in a situation or pattern that is difficult to escape from — 陷入；困在；被某種模式束縛

Adults are not literally caught inside a physical trap. The sentence means that they can become so used to repeating the same routines that it becomes difficult to think or behave differently.

中文翻譯：

成年人往往容易**陷入一成不變的日常模式中**，而像 Leo 這樣的孩子卻可以把一個普通的下午變成一場小小的冒險。

So here:

be trapped in routine = 陷入固定、重複而難以擺脫的日常模式

1. **a trap (捕捉動物的陷阱) — 陷阱；捕獸器**

This is the core literal noun meaning.

Practice 1

> The farmer set a **trap** for the rats.

農夫設了一個**陷阱**來捉老鼠。

Practice 2

> The animal was caught in a **trap**.

那隻動物掉進了**陷阱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

trap = 用來捕捉動物，使其不能逃走的裝置

2. **set a trap — 設陷阱**

Practice 1

> They **set a trap** near the hole.

他們在洞口附近**設下陷阱**。

Practice 2

> The hunters **set several traps** in the forest.

獵人在森林裏**設了幾個陷阱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

set a trap = 放置或準備一個裝置，以捕捉動物或某人

3. **trap an animal/person** — 捕捉；困住

As a verb.

Practice 1

> The cage **trapped the animal**.

籠子把那隻動物**困住了**。

Practice 2

> The police tried to **trap the suspect** inside the building.

警方試圖把疑犯**困在大樓裏**。

MCQ-ready definition:

trap someone/something = 使某人或某物無法離開或逃走

4. **be trapped somewhere** — 被困在某處

Practice 1

> Several people were **trapped inside the lift**.

有幾個人被**困在升降機裏**。

Practice 2

> The hikers were **trapped on the mountain** by heavy snow.

行山人士因大雪而被**困在山上**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be trapped somewhere = 因出口受阻、環境限制等而無法離開某處****

5. ****be trapped under/in something — 被壓住 / 困在某物之中****

Practice 1

> His leg was ****trapped under the fallen tree****.

他的腿被****壓在倒下的樹下****。

Practice 2

> Air can become ****trapped inside the container****.

空氣可能會被****困在容器內****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be trapped under/in something = 因物理阻礙而無法移動或離開****

6. ****trap heat / air / moisture — 留住熱力 / 空氣 / 水分****

A common non-human extension.

Practice 1

> Thick curtains can ****trap heat**** inside the room.

厚窗簾可以把熱力****留在房間裏****。

Practice 2

> The material ****traps moisture**** against the skin.

這種物料會把水分****困在皮膚表面****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trap heat/air/moisture = 阻止某種物質或能量散失，使其留在某個空間內****

7. ****be trapped in a situation (figurative) — 陷入困境****

This is the broad figurative branch used in your passage.

Practice 1

> He felt **trapped in a difficult situation**.

他覺得自己**陷入了一個難以擺脫的困境**。

Practice 2

> She became **trapped in a cycle of stress and overwork**.

她**陷入壓力和過度工作的惡性循環**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be trapped in a situation = 陷入一個難以改變或逃離的處境

8. **be trapped in routine — 陷入一成不變的日常模式**

This is the meaning in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Adults often get **trapped in routine**.

成年人往往容易**陷入一成不變的日常模式**。

Practice 2

> After years in the same job, he felt **trapped in routine**.

在同一份工作做了多年後，他感到自己**被日常規律困住了**。

Practice 3

> Travelling helped her escape from feeling **trapped in routine**.

旅行幫助她擺脫那種**被固定生活模式束縛**的感覺。

MCQ-ready definition:

be trapped in routine = 被固定、重複的生活模式限制，難以改變或嘗試新事物

9. **feel trapped** — 感到受困；感到被束縛

Practice 1

> He **felt trapped** in a job he hated.

他在一份討厭的工作中感到**被困住、無法脫身**。

Practice 2

> She didn't want to **feel trapped** by other people's expectations.

她不想被別人的期望**束縛**。

MCQ-ready definition:

feel trapped = 覺得自己缺乏選擇或自由，難以離開目前處境

10. **be trapped in a relationship/job** — 被困在關係 / 工作中

Practice 1

> She felt **trapped in an unhealthy relationship**.

她覺得自己**被困在一段不健康的關係中**。

Practice 2

> He stayed because he felt financially **trapped in the job**.

他因經濟原因覺得自己**無法離開那份工作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be trapped in a relationship/job = 因各種限制而難以離開某段關係或工作

11. **a trap** (圈套；計謀) — 圈套；陷阱

A figurative noun sense.

Practice 1

> It was a **trap**, and he walked straight into it.

那是一個**圈套**，而他完全中計了。

Practice 2

> The offer sounded attractive, but it turned out to be a **trap**.

那個提議聽起來很吸引，但最後證明是個**圈套**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trap = 為欺騙、捕捉或令某人作出不利行動而設計的圈套****

12. **fall into a trap — 落入圈套；中計**

Practice 1

> Don't **fall into the trap** of believing everything you read online.

不要**掉進這個常見陷阱**，以為網上看到的所有內容都是真的。

Practice 2

> He realized too late that he had **fallen into a trap**.

他太遲才發現自己已經**中計**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fall into a trap = 因受到欺騙或錯誤想法影響而陷入不利情況****

13. **the trap of doing something —這個陷阱 / 常見錯誤**

A very useful abstract pattern.

Practice 1

> Many learners fall into the **trap of translating every word directly**.

很多學習者會掉進**逐字直譯這個陷阱**。

Practice 2

> Don't fall into the **trap of comparing yourself with everyone else**.

不要陷入**不停拿自己跟別人比較的陷阱**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the trap of doing something = 一種看似自然但會造成問題的錯誤做法或思維模式****

14. ****trap someone into doing something — 誘使 / 設計令某人做某事****

Practice 1

> They ****tricked and trapped him into signing the agreement****.

他們設法****誘使他簽署協議****。

Practice 2

> She felt she had been ****trapped into accepting the offer****.

她覺得自己被****逼得 / 設計得不得不接受那個提議****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trap someone into doing something = 透過欺騙、壓力或安排，使某人難以避免做某事****

15. ****poverty trap — 貧窮陷阱****

A social/economic compound.

Practice 1

> Low wages can keep families in a ****poverty trap****.

低工資可能令家庭一直陷於****貧窮陷阱****。

Practice 2

> Education can help people escape the ****poverty trap****.

教育可以幫助人們擺脫****貧窮陷阱****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****poverty trap = 令一個人或家庭難以擺脫貧窮的自我延續處境****

16. **debt trap — 債務陷阱**

Practice 1

> High-interest loans can push borrowers into a **debt trap**.

高息貸款可能令借款人陷入**債務陷阱**。

Practice 2

> He borrowed more money and became caught in a **debt trap**.

他借了更多錢，結果陷入**債務困局**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****debt trap = 因不斷欠債、借新債還舊債而難以脫身的情況****

17. **tourist trap — 專門坑遊客 / 過度商業化的旅遊點**

Informal, usually negative.

Practice 1

> The restaurant looked authentic, but it was really a **tourist trap**.

那間餐廳看似地道，其實只是個**專門做遊客生意、價錢偏高的地方**。

Practice 2

> We avoided the obvious **tourist traps**.

我們避開了那些明顯**過度商業化的旅遊景點**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****tourist trap = 主要吸引遊客消費、通常價錢偏高或品質不如預期的地方****

18. **speed trap — 警方設置的測速執法點**

Practice 1

> Drivers warned each other about a **speed trap** ahead.

駕駛者互相提醒前方有**警方測速執法點**。

Practice 2

> The police had set up a **speed trap** near the school.

警方在學校附近設置了**測速執法點**。

MCQ-ready definition:

speed trap = 警方在某段道路監測並截查超速駕駛者的地方或安排

19. **trapdoor / trap door** — 活板門；地板暗門

Practice 1

> They found a hidden **trapdoor** in the floor.

他們在地板上發現了一道隱藏的**活板門**。

Practice 2

> The actor disappeared through a **trap door** in the stage.

演員從舞台上的**暗門**消失了。

MCQ-ready definition:

trapdoor = 安裝在地板、天花或舞台上，可以開關的隱藏小門

20. **trapped** (心理 / 制度上受限制) — 被束縛的；缺乏選擇的

Practice 1

> Many people feel **trapped** by financial pressure.

很多人因經濟壓力而感到**被束縛、難以脫身**。

Practice 2

> He didn't want to become **trapped** by other people's expectations.

他不想被別人的期望**限制住**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trapped = 因外在或內在限制而覺得缺乏自由和選擇****

21. ****trapper — 捕獸者；設陷阱捕獵的人****

Practice 1

> The ****trapper**** checked his traps early in the morning.

那名****捕獸者****清晨檢查了自己設下的陷阱。

Practice 2

> Historically, ****trappers**** hunted animals for their fur.

歷史上，****捕獸者****會捕獵動物取其毛皮。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trapper = 使用陷阱捕捉動物的人****

22. ****trapping — 設陷阱捕獵****

Practice 1

> Animal ****trapping**** is strictly regulated in the area.

該區對****設陷阱捕獵動物****有嚴格規管。

Practice 2

> He learned traditional ****trapping**** techniques.

他學習了傳統的****設陷阱捕獵技巧****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trapping = 使用陷阱捕捉動物的活動****

23. ****entrap — 設局誘使；誘捕****

More formal than ordinary **trap**.

Practice 1

> The scheme was designed to **entrap** unsuspecting victims.

這個計劃是為了**設局誘騙**毫無戒心的受害者。

Practice 2

> He claimed that he had been **entrapped** into committing the offence.

他聲稱自己是被**設局誘使**犯下該罪行。

MCQ-ready definition:

entrap = 利用圈套、欺騙或引誘令某人陷入某種行動或處境

24. **entrapment (法律)** — 誘捕；誘使犯罪

Legal use, especially common in American legal contexts.

Practice 1

> The defence argued that the case involved **entrapment**.

辯方主張案件涉及**誘捕 / 設局誘使犯罪**。

Practice 2

> **Entrapment** occurs when authorities improperly induce someone to commit an offence.

誘捕指執法人員不當誘使某人作出犯罪行為。

MCQ-ready definition:

entrapment = 執法人員誘使原本未必會犯罪的人作出犯罪行為的法律概念

Important distinction 1: **trap** vs **catch**

catch

very broad: successfully get hold of someone/something.

> **catch a fish**

捉到魚

trap

emphasizes preventing escape.

> **trap an animal**

設法把動物困住

So something can be **caught** without literally being **trapped**.

Important distinction 2: **trap** vs **lock**

trap

the person cannot escape, whether intentionally or accidentally.

> We were **trapped** in the lift.

我們被困在升降機裏。

lock

specifically involves fastening a door/container with a lock or similar mechanism.

> He **locked** the door.

他鎖了門。

A person can be trapped without any door being locked.

Important distinction 3: **trapped** vs **stuck**

These overlap strongly.

stuck

broad and very common.

> I'm ****stuck in traffic****.

我塞在車龍裏。

****trapped****

usually stronger: there is a sense of ****no escape / no freedom****.

> I felt ****trapped in the relationship****.

我覺得自己被困在這段關係中。

So ****trapped**** often sounds more serious psychologically.

Important distinction 4: ****trapped vs caught****

****caught****

may simply mean physically held or discovered.

> My coat got ****caught on a nail****.

我的外套勾在釘子上。

****trapped****

means unable to escape.

> I was ****trapped inside the room****.

我被困在房間裏。

Important distinction 5: ****be trapped in vs be trapped by****

****trapped in + situation/place****

the environment itself contains you.

> trapped ****in a lift****

困在升降機裏

> trapped **in routine**

困在固定日常模式中

trapped by + cause

focuses on what creates the limitation.

> trapped **by debt**

被債務困住

> trapped **by fear**

被恐懼束縛

Important distinction 6: **trap someone vs trap someone into doing something**

trap someone

physically or figuratively prevent escape.

> The fire **trapped them upstairs**.

火災令他們被困在樓上。

trap someone into doing X

maneuver someone into an unwanted action.

> They **trapped him into signing**.

他們設局令他簽了字。

Different grammatical patterns, different focus.

Important distinction 7: **be trapped in routine vs have a routine**

This matters for your passage.

have a routine

neutral:

> I have a morning **routine**.

我有固定的早晨習慣。

be trapped in routine

negative:

> I feel **trapped in routine**.

我覺得自己被一成不變的生活模式**困住了**。

So **routine** itself is not automatically bad. The metaphor **trapped** adds the negative idea of **loss of flexibility and freedom**.

Important distinction 8: **trap vs problem**

A **problem** is simply a difficulty.

A **trap** often contains the extra idea that:

- * it is easy to enter,
- * difficult to leave,
- * or something looks harmless but causes trouble.

So:

> a **debt problem**

債務問題

is broader than:

> a **debt trap**

難以脫身的債務陷阱

Important distinction 9: **trap vs trick**

trick

a deceptive act.

trap

the situation designed to catch or disadvantage someone.

> He used a **trick** to get me there.

他用了個騙人的手段令我去那裏。

> Once I arrived, I realized it was a **trap**.

到了之後，我才發現那是一個圈套。

Important distinction 10: **trap vs entrap**

trap

ordinary, broad English.

entrap

more formal and often involves deliberate deception or legal contexts.

> She felt **trapped** in the situation.

她覺得自己困在那個情況裏。

> Police were accused of **entrapping** him.

警方被指設局誘使他犯罪。

Important distinction 11: **fall into a trap vs be trapped**

fall into a trap

focuses on **entering** the problem.

> He **fell into the trap** of overspending.

他掉進過度消費的陷阱。

be trapped

focuses on **remaining unable to escape**.

> He became **trapped in debt**.

他陷入債務困局。

Important distinction 12: literal vs figurative **trap**

Literal

> The animal was **trapped in a cage**.

動物被困在籠裏。

Figurative

> Adults get **trapped in routine**.

成年人被固定日常模式束縛。

The metaphorical path is very clear:

****physical escape becomes impossible****

→ ****psychological/social change becomes difficult****

Family-extension note

****Trap**** is a strong polysemy candidate because its concrete core develops very naturally into abstract uses.

The central concept is:

****someone or something becomes unable to escape****

From that we get:

1. ****physical trapping****

- * animal trap
- * trapped in a lift

2. **containment**

- * trap heat
- * trap air

3. **psychological/social restriction**

- * trapped in routine
- * trapped in a job
- * feel trapped

4. **deception**

- * a trap
- * fall into a trap
- * trap someone into doing something

5. **lexicalized compounds**

- * poverty trap
- * debt trap
- * tourist trap
- * speed trap

These are connected enough that we should preserve the common semantic image, while still distinguishing the literal, figurative, and deception branches.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
a trap (animal)	陷阱；捕獸器	catches/prevents escape	
set a trap	設陷阱	prepare capture	
trap an animal/person	捕捉；困住	prevent escape	
be trapped somewhere	被困在某處	unable to leave	
trapped under X	被壓 / 困在 X 下	physical restriction	
trap heat/air	留住熱力 / 空氣	prevent escape	
trapped in a situation	陷入困境	figurative restriction	
trapped in routine	陷入一成不變的日常	restricted by routine	
feel trapped	感到受困 / 被束縛	lack freedom	
trap (scheme)	圈套	deceptive setup	

fall into a trap	中計；掉進陷阱	enter harmful situation	
trap of doing X	做 X 的陷阱	common harmful pattern	
trap someone into X	誘使 / 逼使某人做 X	maneuver into action	
poverty trap	貧窮陷阱	difficult-to-escape poverty	
debt trap	債務陷阱	self-perpetuating debt	
tourist trap	坑遊客 / 商業化旅遊點	exploitative attraction	
speed trap	測速執法點	catches speeding drivers	
trapdoor	活板門；暗門	hidden opening	
trapper	捕獸者	person who traps	
trapping	設陷阱捕獵	trapping activity	
entrap	設局誘使	formal deceptive trapping	
entrapment	誘捕	legal inducement	

For your original sentence

> **Adults often get trapped in routine**, whereas children like Leo can turn an ordinary afternoon into a little adventure.

Here:

get trapped in routine = 陷入固定、重複而難以擺脫的生活模式

The metaphor is:

physical trap

→ **you cannot escape**

→ **routine becomes like a trap that limits how you think and live**

So the sentence is not saying adults simply **have routines**.

It is saying that adults can become **too bound by routine**, losing spontaneity and imagination.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> **成年人往往容易陷入一成不變的日常模式中**，而像 Leo 這樣的孩子卻能把一個普通的下午變成一場小小的冒險。

For this passage, the key sense is therefore the **figurative “become stuck in a restrictive situation/pattern” sense of **trap**.